



Introduction to problem-solving and effective questioning

Welcome to the second course in the Google Data Analytics certificate.

If you completed Course One, we met briefly at the beginning,

but for those of you who are just joining us,

my name is Ximena, and I'm a Google Finance data analyst.

I think it's really wonderful that you're here with me

learning about the fascinating field of data analytics.

Learning and education have always been very important to me.

When I was young, my mom always said, "I can't leave you an **inheritance**, but

I can give you an education that

opens doors." That always pushed me to keep learning, and

that education gave me the confidence to apply for my job at Google.

Now I get to do really meaningful work every day.

Just recently I worked as an analyst on a team called Verily Life Sciences.

We were helping to get life-saving medical supplies to those who need it most.

To do this, we forecasted what health care professionals would need on hand and

then shared that information with networks.

The information that my team provided helped make

data driven decisions that actually saved lives.

I'm thrilled to be your instructor for this course.

We're going to talk about the difference between **effective and**

ineffective questions and learn **how to ask great questions** that lead

to insights that can help you solve business problems.

You will discover that effective questions help you to make the most of all the data analysis phases. You may remember that these phases include ask, prepare, process, analyze, share, and act.

In the **ask step**, **we define the problem we're solving** and make sure that we **fully understand stakeholder expectations**.

This will help keep you focused on the actual problem, which leads to more successful outcomes.

So we'll begin this course by talking about problem solving and some of the common types of business problems that data analysts help solve.

And because **this course focuses on the ask phase**, you'll learn how to **craft** effective questions that help you collect the right data to solve those problems.

Next, we'll talk about the many different types of data.

You'll learn how and when each is the most useful.

You'll also get a chance to explore spreadsheets further and discover how they can help make your data analysis even more effective.

And **then we'll start learning about structured thinking**.

Structured thinking is the process of recognizing the current problem or situation, organizing available information, revealing gaps and opportunities, and identifying the options.

In this process, you address a **vague**, complex problem by breaking it down into smaller steps, and then those steps lead you to a logical solution. We'll work together to be sure you fully understand how to use structured thinking and data analysis.

Finally, we'll learn some **proven strategies for communicating** with others effectively.

I can't wait to share more about my passion for data analytics with you, so let's get started.

